❷ Adds optional database services to enhance the DeveloperExceptionPage

❸ Adds the Identity system, including the default UI, and configures the user type as IdentityUser

❹ Requires users to confirm their accounts (typically by email) before they log in

❺ Configures Identity to store its data in EF Core

The `AddDefaultIdentity()` extension method does several things:

- Adds the core ASP.NET Core Identity services.
- Configures the application user type to be `IdentityUser`. This is the entity model that is stored in the database and represents a "user" in your application. You can extend this type if you need to, but that's not always necessary, as you'll see in section 23.6.
- Adds the default UI Razor Pages for registering, logging in, and managing users.
- Configures token providers for generating MFA and email confirmation tokens.

Where is the authentication middleware?

If you're already familiar with previous versions of ASP.NET Core, you might be surprised to notice the lack of any authentication middleware in the default template. Given everything you've learned about how authentication works, that *should* be surprising!

The answer to this riddle is that the authentication middleware *is* in the pipeline, even though you can't see it. As I discussed in chapter 4, `WebApplication` automatically adds many middleware components to the pipeline for you, including the routing middleware, the endpoint middleware, and —yes—the authentication middleware. So the reason you don't see it in the pipeline is that it's already been added.

In fact, `WebApplication` also automatically adds the *authorization* middleware to the pipeline, but in this case the template still calls `UseAuthorization()`. Why? For the same reason that the template also calls `UseRouting()`: to control exactly where in the pipeline the middleware is added.

As I mentioned in chapter 4, you can override the automatically added middleware by adding it yourself manually. It's crucial that the authorization middleware be placed *after* the routing